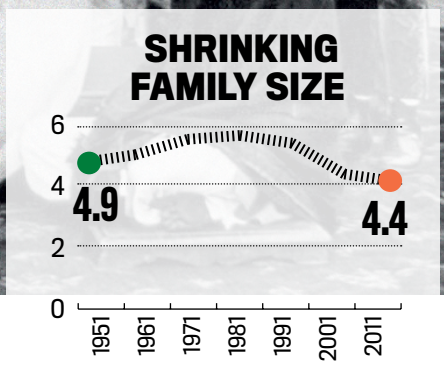
INDIA PICTURE



TIES THAT ENDURE
A Parsi family at a wedding in the late 19th century; right, a man takes a photo of his wife and children

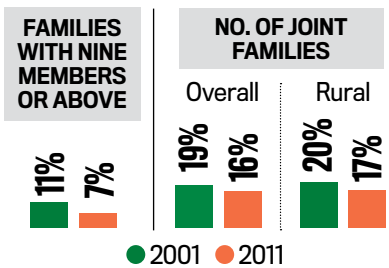


STRONG BONDS

The atoms and molecules that make up Indian society may look and act different, but at their core the family retains its salience

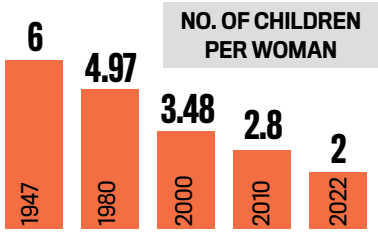
By Sonali Acharjee

How we live, who we live with and how we socialise has undergone a drastic change, but not always in predictable ways, in the past 75 years. In 1981, Indian families had an average size of 5.6 people—counter-intuitively, the highest since 1947, when it had been only 4.9. Since then, it was all nuclear proliferation. Average households now have 4.45 members. The share of joint families has dipped to 16 per cent. Today, families with two, one or no children are common; the preference



REDUCING FERTILITY RATE

A total fertility rate of 2.1 children per woman ensures a broadly stable population. Currently, India's fertility rate is below the replacement figure indicating a tendency to have less children.



Source: NFHS